Tabletop Kickstarter Launch Kit

Start here

Price the rewards, check the cash, and turn the remaining work into a dated launch plan. This kit is for board games, card games, TTRPGs, miniatures and accessories.

Start with a copy of the workbook. It contains a complete fictional example so you can see the formulas work. Replace blue inputs with your project details before relying on any result.

Your five working files

File	Use it for
Tabletop-Launch-Planner.xlsx	Reward economics, MOQ, shipping, cash timing and launch trackers
Campaign-and-Email-Templates.docx	One page plan, campaign outline, rewards, 12 emails and outreach drafts
Creative-and-Production-Briefs.docx	Asset brief, storyboard, ad tests, quote request and fulfillment handoff
Examples-and-Sources.pdf	Five category examples, a worked financial case and official references
START-HERE.pdf	The order to use the kit and important model boundaries

Your first thirty minutes

1. Save a project copy. In Start, enter your project, currency, launch date and active case. Read the assumptions beside each rate.

2. In Costs, replace the unit cost, MOQ, order increment and fixed costs. In Rewards, replace prices, mix, units and other costs.

3. In Shipping, replace zones, mix and parcel quotes. Choose Later, At pledge or Included on Start.

4. Read Funding and Cash. Resolve a cash gap, missing input or unconfirmed quote before choosing a public goal.

Read the model correctly

Tab	Your next decision
Start	Which assumptions and case are active?
Funding	Can the whole order and reserves be funded?
Rewards	Does each tier contribute after its costs?
Costs	What must be paid and what does the quote exclude?
Shipping	Which zones are supported and when are charges collected?
Cash	Is money available before each payment is due?
Launch plan	Who owns each dependency and dated task?
Ad tests	What evidence would justify spending again?
Sources	What does each reporting source actually attribute?
Reviewers	Which outreach is relevant, agreed and permitted?
Live ops	What needs action and what has been verified?
Production	Which version, sample and handoff are approved?

What this starter workbook covers

One manufactured product SKU can be used by several physical reward tiers, alongside digital rewards with zero physical units. The example is one base game, a two copy bundle and a digital print and play. Additional independent SKUs need complete separate costing.

All amounts use the campaign currency. Convert external quotes explicitly before entering them. The model does not determine tax liability, calculate tariffs, integrate with a supplier, or prove demand.

One weighted parcel cost is used per physical backer. A larger bundle may need a larger parcel. Enter the additional cost in the reward other cost or use confirmed tier specific shipping quotes.

Funding is also a cash decision

A positive margin can still leave you short of cash. Minimum orders require paying for units that may remain unsold. Pledges are not money available before payout. Shipping collected later cannot pay an earlier factory deposit.

A fictional MOQ example

Suppose a reward is $35, manufacturing is $14 per unit, other reward cost is $3 per backer, fixed work is $6,000 and the supplier MOQ is 500. This example uses US standard 5% platform plus 3% and $0.30 processing, with no shipping, failures, reserves or opening cash.

Backers	Net receipts	Costs with MOQ	Surplus or gap
403	$12,855.70	$14,209.00	($1,353.30)
450	$14,355.00	$14,350.00	$5.00

A simple per reward margin suggests 403 backers. The full order model shows the $1,353.30 gap. Even 450 backers leaves only $5 before contingency or other uncertainty. These are arithmetic examples, not a recommended campaign budget.

The checks to complete

Confirm that reward and shipping mixes total 100%. Confirm that prices and unit quantities are nonnegative, order increments are at least one, and every required input is present. Obtain real production and shipping quotes. Set a tax plan, reserve and realistic payment schedule.

In Cash, blue date fields can be replaced with agreed milestone dates. Keep the event rows chronological. Add a committed extra receipt or payment in the extra rows. The minimum balance identifies the funding needed before those events.

Move from plan to launch

Choose your category path

Category	Start with this proof
Board game	Rules, one observed turn, full component BOM and packed weight
Card game	Deck specification, print run cost and parcel economics
TTRPG	Quickstart, editorial milestones, PDF access and print proof
Miniatures	Physical or STL scope, scale, test print, rights and packout
Accessories	Dimensions, compatibility, fit test and material specification

Use the copy with verified details

The editable drafts contain real sample wording and bracketed fields. Replace every field before sending. Delete unsupported statements. Keep dates, prices, contents and shipping wording consistent with the live campaign.

Use newsletters only for people who opted in. Keep required reward and delivery communication separate. Use a reviewer business contact and submission policy. Record permission before reusing quotes, logos or footage.

Before you commit money or go live

Complete the launch readiness checklist in the campaign document. Resolve product proof, rights, quotes, cash timing, bank and identity checks, platform review, support ownership and email delivery. A planned date alone does not make a campaign ready.

Where to read more

Guildframe guides: https://guildframe.com/guides

Kickstarter Creator Handbook: https://www.kickstarter.com/help/handbook

Official fee, shipping, tax, attribution and rules references are in Examples and Sources. Check current country and provider terms before setting final figures.

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